## TRUE UP THE BASE

- The bowl gouge needs to be used with the bevel rubbing and the flute of the gouge facing away at around 2 o'clock. This requires a good knowledge of the gouge
- The parting tool is my least favourite as it gives a poor finish to the end grain but, unfortunately, is the easiest to use
- The skew chisel is my favourite by far and leaves a far superior finish, but I know that a lot of turners have a dread of this tool and will understand if they opt for something else

## DUST EXTRACTION

At this point it's a good time to talk about dust and dust control. In these pictures, the dust is being taken away with the extractor and you can see the dust stream as it heads toward the extractor nozzle. This efficiency is greatly reduced, the further the nozzle is away from the work. On a long piece like this it might mean not all dust is taken out of the atmosphere, so good personal dust protection is also important. A powered dust visor produces positive pressure on the inside, keeping the dust away from the face and also protects from injury

2 Now to start roughing down the blank. Use a 25mm roughing gouge ground to around 40°. I use this gouge for most things, only going up to my 30mm gouge when the size of the project increases greatly. At this stage only rough down until the corners are gone and are nearly round, but don't worry if you have a couple of flats left. This is also the stage to clean up the end grain at the tailstock end, this will eventually be the base of the candlestick so think about that when mounting the rough blank to begin with. To true up the base you have several options: either a bowl gouge, parting tool or skew. Whichever option you choose, the base needs to be very slightly concave so the candlestick sits without rocking

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3 Once you have roughed down the blank, turn the piece over so your now trued base is at the head stock. Finish roughing down to a complete round. When the blank has been roughed down, start shaping at the base and the largest diameter, then move to any detail in the later stages. Here you can see I'm working on the main body. Clean up with a 30mm skew chisel

4 Once the base is roughed into shape and some basic cleaning up has been done, move onto the top of the candlestick. Start by taking the diameter down to size, then plot out where the detail will go – tweaking as you go to fit into the parameters of the blank

5 Once you're happy with the shape, start the go over the detail and make sure all the features are crisp. Simply by offering the long point of the skew into the 'V' cuts ,you will make your beads really pop out

6 After your tweaking has been done it's time to start sanding. Start at 100 grit and work your way up through 150, 240, 320 and 400 grit. It is important, however, to make sure any tears or tooling marks are gone before you move up to 150 grit, otherwise they will more than likely still be there at the end

7 When sanding the fine detail on your candlestick it's important to mould the abrasive to the shape you've turned. Lazy sanding will flatten the top of beads and round over fillets, so fold and mould your abrasive to shape



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